



▲ BERTHIER CARBINE

Date 1907

Origin France

Barrel 15in (38cm)

Caliber 8mm

The French military authorities replaced the tubular-magazine Lebel rifle (see p.147) with the Berthier carbine, which used the same bolt mechanism but had a box magazine. Its capacity of only three rounds, however, was a major flaw. The carbine was first introduced into service in 1902. This example was built in 1907.



▲ ENFIELD PATTERN 1913

Date 1913

Origin UK

Barrel 26in (66cm)

Caliber .276in

This experimental design was produced as a potential replacement for Lee-Enfield's SMLE, firing a more powerful .276in round. At the start of World War I, manufacturing problems with this new Pattern 1913 rifle resulted in a further change in caliber.



▲ ENFIELD PATTERN 1914

Date 1914

Origin UK

Barrel 26in (66cm)

Caliber .303in Mauser

Around the onset of World War I, the Pattern 1913 rifle was modified to use the .303in chambering, and the weapon was redesignated as the Pattern 1914. The Model 1917, a .30in-caliber version of the Pattern 1914, was later adopted by the US Army.

▲ BERTHIER MLE 1916

Date 1916

Origin France

Barrel 31½in (79.8cm)

Caliber 8 × 50mm

Although the Berthier carbine (top) continued to use the bolt action of the Lebel, it was outmoded in appearance, due to the length of its barrel. However, its only serious defect lay in its limited magazine capacity. Seen here is a modified version issued in 1916, with an enlarged five-round magazine.